It is also worth noting that voting is rare in the IMF; decisions are usually made by the practice of reaching the "sense of the meeting," or consensus, as determined by the managing director. This convention works to limit accountability and transparency (unless summaries of positions are available) and testifies to the prevalence of informal rules in U.S.-led governance institutions. Western scholars also have noted that this practice has allowed the United States "to veil its power through conventions that convinced other countries that the rules of the game were reasonably fair or at least better than no rules at all," while still favoring those with greater power resources.[35]

In the aftermath of Washington's ratification of the 14th Quota Reform, the BRICS governments started emphasizing the need to accelerate the timeline for the delayed 15th Quota Reform. Lagarde pushed a timeline of October 2017 for the next shareholding review in the IMF. Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi acknowledged that the long-pending quota revisions have finally come into effect, but complained that "even now, IMF quotas do not reflect the global economic realities."[36]

According to Indian Finance Minister Arun Jaitley, a new quota formula will enhance the voice, role, and voting shares of developing countries. On the sidelines of the Spring 2016 meetings of the World Bank and IMF, Jaitley also pushed for another review of the World Bank's voting shares and for additional concessional financing for infrastructure investment, almost doubling its annual funding volumes. Further, he stated that the representation of Indians in the top management of the World Bank should be increased.[37] In Hangzhou, China, at a BRICS meeting on the sidelines of the G20 summit in 2016, Vladimir Putin approvingly noted that the combined share of the BRICS was 14.89 percent, "coming close to the blocking threshold of 15 percent," but added that the countries needed to move further in pushing IMF reforms.[38]

The BRICS as Creditors: Bargaining to Compel Reforms

It was to be expected that reforming the incumbent order would be difficult, given the inherent distributional conflicts that arise with pressures for change in governance institutions. Even when they collaborated, the BRICS had to rely mostly on persuasion until they were prepared to exercise their outside options (Case 3). Absent a credible threat to exit, even partway, the BRICS did not possess sufficient bargaining power to compel others to share leadership roles and give up privileges and positions—at least not until the